international forums; in fact, he had been told to make favourable references to these two countries whenever opportunities arose.

The then foreign secretary Kewal Singh met Chaudhury at Lima, where Chaudhury told him that Sheikh Mujib had lost much of his charisma over the previous three years and that the drastic and arbitrary changes which Sheikh Mujib had made in the constitution were a great mistake since by putting himself above parliament, he had lost the basis for legitimacy. Kewal Singh said in a note:

While agreeing that Sheikh Mujib was a great leader who had worked for IndoBangladesh friendship, Chaudhury was of the view that his advisors were not as sincere in their feelings towards India and, in this connection, he particularly referred to Kamal Hossain. Chaudhury said that he personally would like to maintain very friendly relations with India, but added that he would have to act very tactfully. Chaudhury also said that he had sometimes advised Sheikh Mujib that there was mounting discontentment in many circles and he should pay due regard to it but Sheikh, however, replied that he knew how to handle the situation and deal with the trouble makers. Chaudhury felt that Sheikh Mujib had become overconfident and didn't realise, even till the end, that there was grave danger to himself and his government. There had also been talk among the younger elements in the army that on the advice of India, Sheikh Mujib was keeping the Bangladeshi army small and weak. Sheikh Mujib even used to mention to his colleagues that in case of difficulty, he would call on the Indian army and this gave currency to rumours that his wrong actions were on the advice of India.